Six more countries demand halt to EU's new emissions trading scheme

送信者: POLITICO Pro Alert 受信日時: 2026-10-15 20:51

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Six more countries demand halt to EU's new emissions trading scheme
By Ben Makuch, Ben Munster · Oct 15, 2026, 1:50 PM · View in your browser

BRUSSELS — A coalition of six countries has called for a two-year delay to a new EU carbon price on heating and transport, arguing the scheme would increase energy prices that are already soaring thanks to wars in Iran and Ukraine.

Italy and Greece joined the so-called Visegrad four — Poland, Czechia, Hungary, and Slovakia — in calling for the delay of ETS2 at a summit of European heads of state and government in Brussels, according to five EU diplomats.

Earlier on Thursday, Estonian Prime Minister Kristen Michal also called for ETS2 to be delayed — or scrapped altogether.

ETS2 is a new EU-wide emissions trading system that will put a price on carbon emissions from transport and heating. It's already been delayed by a year, and is currently due to come into full force in 2028.

The countries ask the European Commission "for a reassessment of the ETS2, [particularly] its design, safeguards and implementation timeline with the view to further postpone its entry into the force until at least 2030." They cite "soaring energy prices" and the "differences in electricity prices."

One diplomat stressed that the text is not final and that an updated position — potentially featuring further input from Italy — is still to come.

The countries are part of a broader gang of EU governments pushing for a further weakening of the original Emissions Trading System, which applies to heavy industry and power generators. Council and Parliament are both currently debating the EU executive's July review of the ETS.

Oppositely, the Nordics defended the EU's green agenda and their companies who "have invested billions of euros in decarbonisation, clean technologies, electrification and industrial transformation," in a letter on ETS released this morning .

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